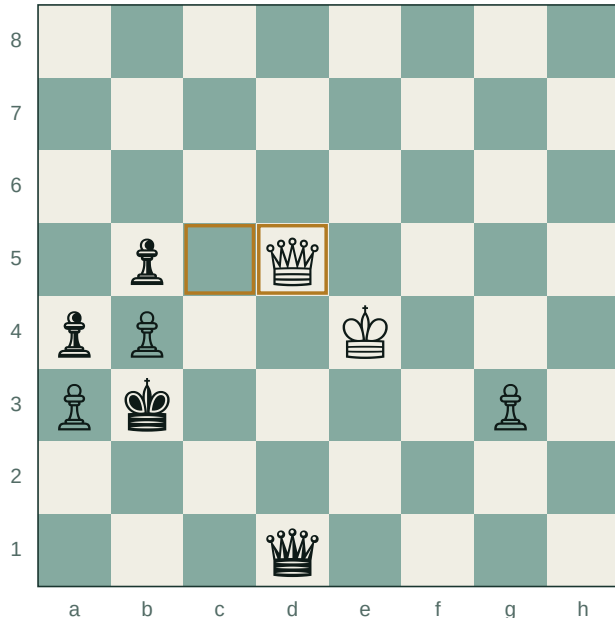


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 69

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 69.Qd5+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

69...Qxd5+ 70. Kxd5 Kxa3

69...Qxd5+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on d5. Recorded reply: **70.Kxd5.**

70...Kxa3 The king captures the pawn on a3.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 2 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from -1 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on e4. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.